2 The Listeners

Poem *

Warm Up

You are walking into a grove at 12 noon. You feel that somebody is following you. When you look behind, nobody is there. How would you feel? What would you do? Share it in the class.

EIMCDH

Memoriter

Is there anybody there?' said the Traveller,
Knocking on the moonlit door;
And his horse in the silence **champed** the grasses
Of the forest's **ferny** floor: And a bird flew up out of the **turret**,
Above the Traveller's head:
And he **smote** upon the door again a second time;
'Is there anybody there?' he said.
But no one descended to the Traveller;
No head from the leaf-fringed **sill**
Leaned over and looked into his grey eyes,
Where he stood **perplexed** and still.
But only a host of phantom listeners
That dwelt in the lone house then
Stood listening in the quiet of the moonlight
To that voice from the world of men:
Stood **thronging** the faint moonbeams on the dark stair,
That goes down to the empty hall,
Hearkening in an air stirred and shaken
By the lonely Traveller's call.

Walter de la Mare

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